A Forgotten Fossil Turns Out to Be a New Dinosaur

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A dinosaur **fossil** sat almost unnoticed in a museum for nearly 100 years. Now scientists say it is a brand-new kind of dinosaur. It lived about 120 million years ago in what is now Britain.

Scientists led by University College London studied a piece of the dinosaur's **skull**. It was found on the Isle of Wight, an island near England. A museum in London got it in 1924.

The dinosaur is named Invictibellatrix amberina. The name means "unconquered female warrior." It was a **megaraptoran**, a **meat-eater** with strong arms and big curved claws.

Dr. Cassius Morrison said it was about as tall as a person and three to four meters long. It probably had **feathers** and ate small animals. People and dinosaurs never lived at the same time.

It is the first **megaraptoran** ever found in Europe. That helps show how these dinosaurs spread around the world.

Word Treasure

fossil -- A fossil is what is left of a plant or animal from very long ago, saved in rock.

meat-eater -- A meat-eater is an animal that eats other animals.

skull -- A skull is the bony part of the head.

megaraptoran -- A megaraptoran was a meat-eating dinosaur with strong arms and big curved claws.

feathers -- Feathers are the soft parts that cover birds, and some dinosaurs had them too.

Background you need

Fossils help scientists learn about animals that lived millions of years ago.

Museums keep many fossils, and some are not studied closely for years.

Scientists can tell an animal is new by comparing its bones with others.

Break it down

WHO: Scientists led by University College London
WHAT: Found that an old museum fossil is a new dinosaur, Invictibellatrix amberina
WHERE: The fossil came from the Isle of Wight, near England
WHY: It is the first megaraptoran found in Europe and shows how these dinosaurs spread

Why it matters

It shows that exciting discoveries can be hiding in museums, waiting for someone to look closely.

Test what you remember

1. How long did the fossil sit unnoticed in a museum?

- (A) 1,000 years
- (B) Nearly 100 years
- (C) Five years
- (D) One week

2. About how long ago did the dinosaur live?

- (A) About 5,000 years ago
- (B) Last year
- (C) About 120 million years ago
- (D) About 100 years ago

3. Where was the fossil found?

- (A) In a city park
- (B) In a desert in Asia
- (C) At the North Pole
- (D) On the Isle of Wight

4. What does the name Invictibellatrix mean?

- (A) Big tooth
- (B) Little runner
- (C) Unconquered female warrior
- (D) Fast flyer

5. About how tall was the dinosaur?

- (A) As small as a mouse
- (B) As tall as a giraffe
- (C) About as tall as a person
- (D) As tall as a house

6. Why is the fossil special?

- (A) It can still walk
- (B) It is the first megaraptoran found in Europe
- (C) It was found on the Moon
- (D) It is made of gold

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: C 3: D 4: C 5: C 6: B

Questions to think about

1. Dr. Cassius Morrison: He says the dinosaur was about as tall as a person and probably had feathers.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):